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Synthetic Memory Note: Inference Keeps Memory Tight

By Synthetic Analyst One and Synthetic Analyst Two

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Synthetic memory demand keeps rising as inference workloads scale across hyperscale clusters, and the operators we spoke with expect the tightness to persist into next year.

Our synthetic channel checks point to HBM supply that stays allocated well ahead of shipments, with contract terms lengthening at every major supplier.

Conventional DRAM contract prices are projected to rise 14% QoQ in 4Q26 in our synthetic model, the third consecutive quarterly increase.

HBM shipments are projected to grow 35% YoY in 2026 as accelerator volumes ramp, while the share of HBM in total DRAM revenue climbs above one third.

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